

Phenomenology (Husserl) — MCQ Questions

55-question closed-book bank · no answer key

Attempt closed-book. Answers, explanations, traps and mappings are intentionally absent from this file.

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MCQ 1

In Husserl's 1911 programme of philosophy as a rigorous science, what kind of discipline should phenomenology become?

- A. Phenomenology should become an empirical psychology that classifies observable mental states.
- B. Phenomenology should become a metaphysical proof establishing the existence of a divine guarantor.
- C. Phenomenology should become a historical survey comparing successive philosophical worldviews.
- D. Phenomenology should become a presuppositionless rigorous science describing structures of consciousness.

MCQ 2

What methodological demand does Husserl express through the slogan 'to the things themselves'?

- A. The slogan demands fidelity to subject matters as they are given in experience.
- B. The slogan demands a return to naive realism about independently existing physical things.
- C. The slogan reduces philosophical inquiry to explanations supplied by the natural sciences.
- D. The slogan replaces careful description with unrestricted metaphysical speculation about hidden realities.

MCQ 3

How are method, theory of essences and avoidance of psychologism related within Husserl's phenomenological project?

- A. They are independent doctrines without a shared philosophical purpose or argumentative sequence within Husserl's philosophy.
- B. They are merely biographical periods arranged by dates in Husserl's intellectual career.
- C. They are separate polemics directed exclusively against three claims made by Heidegger.
- D. The three limbs are integrated within one project of method, eidetic disclosure and ideal validity.

MCQ 4

Which developmental account correctly relates Husserl's Logical Investigations and Ideas I?

- A. The Crisis was published before Logical Investigations and supplied its anti-psychologistic foundation.
- B. Husserl inherited the noesis and noema vocabulary unchanged from Brentano's descriptive psychology.
- C. Husserl's writings present one fixed doctrine without any descriptive or transcendental development.
- D. Logical Investigations foregrounds descriptive anti-psychologism, while Ideas I develops transcendental noetic-noematic analysis.

MCQ 5

What does Husserl call the general thesis operating within the natural attitude?

A. It is the tacit standing posit that the world exists independently and is already there. B. It is the theological belief that divine veracity guarantees each perceptual judgement. C. It is the logical doctrine that valid inference records empirical habits of thinking. D. It is the metaphysical doctrine that essences subsist as separated Platonic Forms.

MCQ 6

Which assessment best states Husserl's criticism of the natural attitude?

A. The natural attitude is false in ordinary life and therefore must be permanently abandoned. B. The natural attitude demonstrates that the independently existing world is philosophically unreal and thereby establishes scepticism. C. The natural attitude performs the same methodological operation as Descartes' radical doubt. D. The natural attitude remains practically valid and uncritical about how worldly meaning is constituted.

MCQ 7

Why does Husserl hold that the natural sciences cannot provide their own ultimate philosophical grounding?

A. Natural sciences remain within the natural attitude and presuppose the domains whose meaning requires clarification. B. Natural sciences already occupy a transcendental standpoint outside worldly positing altogether. C. Natural sciences routinely perform the epoché before formulating hypotheses about empirical objects. D. Natural sciences investigate the transcendental ego rather than regions of constituted worldly being as their exclusive subject matter.

MCQ 8

How does Husserl explain the identity of one spatial object across changing perspectival appearances?

A. Profiles are synthesised within internal and external horizons as appearances of one enduring object. B. Private sense-data are first isolated and then used to infer an inaccessible external cause before constructing object identity. C. All sides of the spatial object is simultaneously presented in a single complete perception. D. A separately existing Platonic Form guarantees identity independently of perceptual synthesis.

MCQ 9

What operation does Husserl name epoché or bracketing?

A. Epoché denies that any external world exists beyond the subject's current experiences. B. Epoché proves that mental being alone survives any possible form of philosophical doubt. C. Epoché suspends the natural attitude's existence-posit without affirming or denying the world. D. Epoché proposes an empirical hypothesis explaining the psychological causes of perceptual experience.

MCQ 10

How does Husserl's epoché differ from Descartes' methodological doubt?

A. Both methods deny the world's existence so that certainty can be reconstructed from an isolated subject. B. Epoché searches for a thinking substance, while Cartesian doubt merely describes experiential givenness. C. Cartesian doubt questions the doubtful, while epoché suspends the natural attitude's existence-posit. D. Cartesian doubt is passive observation, while epoché infers an external world from private data.

MCQ 11

What remains available for inquiry after Husserl performs epoché and enters phenomenological reduction?

A. A Cartesian thinking substance remains as a mental thing opposed to bodily substance and survives doubt as self-existing. B. The intentional stream remains as lived experience and as the field of modes of givenness. C. The empirical psyche remains as a natural object investigated by experimental psychology. D. No describable content remains because bracketing removes both world and consciousness.

MCQ 12

Which statement correctly distinguishes Husserl's epoché, phenomenological reduction and eidetic reduction?

A. Epoché and phenomenological reduction both deny existence, while eidetic reduction restores factual belief. B. Phenomenological reduction extracts essences, while epoché redirects inquiry toward transcendental subjectivity. C. Epoché suspends world-positing, phenomenological reduction redirects inquiry to givenness, and eidetic reduction varies for essences. D. Epoché isolates sensory matter, phenomenological reduction proves objects, and eidetic reduction studies mental causes under alternative descriptions of one result.

MCQ 13

A Husserlian researcher brackets whether a remembered city exists exactly as recalled and then examines how the city is presented through recollection, anticipation and possible confirmation. Which operation is most directly exemplified by the second move?

A. Phenomenological reduction redirects inquiry to the city's modes of givenness and their constitutive correlation. B. Epoché alone completes the analysis because suspension itself describes every structure through which the city is intended. C. Eidetic reduction compares remembered cities statistically to infer their most frequent empirical characteristics. D. Transcendental reduction proves that the researcher's empirical psyche causally creates the remembered city.

MCQ 14

What is the functional relation between suspension and phenomenological reduction in Husserl's method?

A. Suspension withholds natural-attitude positing, while reduction redirects inquiry toward modes of givenness. B. Suspension denies the external world, while reduction subsequently proves and restores that same world. C. Suspension and phenomenological reduction are both alternative names for free imaginative eidetic variation. D. Suspension and phenomenological reduction are forms of introspection examining private empirical mental events.

MCQ 15

What does intentionality mean in Husserl's analysis of consciousness?

A. Intentionality means that mental states remain unconscious until reflective attention makes it explicit. B. Intentionality means that consciousness requires a corresponding external object that actually exists. C. Intentionality means that consciousness is essentially directed toward something as its intended object. D. Intentionality means that conscious acts include a deliberate plan for moral action.

MCQ 16

Within Husserl's noesis-noema correlation, what does the noema designate?

A. The noema designates non-intentional sensory matter before it receives an apprehensive form. B. The noema designates the physical cause that produces a perceptual event in consciousness. C. The noema designates a private mental image positioned between consciousness and the world. D. The noema designates the object precisely as intended or the act's sense-structure.

MCQ 17

Can hallucination count as an intentional act within Husserl's account of directed consciousness?

A. Hallucination cannot be intentional because intentional acts require an actually existing object. B. Hallucination is intentional because it has a genuine act and a determinate object as meant. C. Hallucination cannot be intentional because a nonveridical experience has no noematic correlate. D. Hallucination becomes intentional solely when later perception confirms that its object was real.

MCQ 18

What does Husserl's principle of all principles in Ideas I authorize as evidence?

- A. Originary intuition licenses acceptance of what is given within the limits of its manner of givenness.
- B. Empirical psychology licenses logical laws whenever most subjects report the same inferential habit.
- C. Natural belief licenses the independent world's existence without examining how objects are presented.
- D. Intellectual vision licenses belief in essences as entities separated from possible experience altogether.

MCQ 19

Which account correctly distinguishes noesis and noema in Husserl's intentional analysis?

- A. Noesis manufactures the world causally, while noema names the resulting physical object.
- B. Noesis names the intentional act-side, while noema names its object-as-meant correlate.
- C. Noesis suspends external existence, while noema proves that the external world is unreal.
- D. Noesis and noema name two physiological mechanisms located within the perceiving brain.

MCQ 20

Which description is safest when interpreting the noema in Husserl's Ideas I?

- A. The noema is the object-as-intended or sense-structure, with details disputed among interpreters.
- B. The noema is a private picture that consciousness inspects instead of encountering the world.
- C. The noema is invariably identical with the physical object existing outside any intentional act.
- D. The noema is a deliberate purpose formed before a person chooses to perform an action.

MCQ 21

Within Husserl's hyle-morphe analysis, what role belongs to hyle?

- A. Hyle is the intentional form that animates sensory matter into an object-directed experience.
- B. Hyle is non-intentional sensory matter lived through rather than perceived as the intended object.
- C. Hyle is the noematic object exactly as it is meant by a particular intentional act.
- D. Hyle is a timeless Platonic essence disclosed independently of sensuous experiential content.

MCQ 22

Why does Husserl's hyle-morphe account resist a classical veil-of-ideas theory of perception?

- A. Perception begins with private sense-data from which consciousness infers an external worldly cause.
- B. Hyletic matter is itself the object perceived before intentional form interprets its properties.
- C. Hyletic matter is lived through rather than observed, so perception directly intends the worldly object.
- D. Consciousness compares inner pictures with outer objects to determine whether representation is accurate.

MCQ 23

Which three moments compose the living present in Husserl's analysis of inner time-consciousness?

- A. The living present includes retention, primal impression and protention as an internally articulated flow.
- B. The living present follows thesis, antithesis and synthesis as successive dialectical logical stages.
- C. The living present combines epoché, phenomenological reduction and constitution as temporal phases.
- D. The living present joins hyle, morphe and noema as three chronological moments.

MCQ 24

How does Husserl distinguish retention from recollection in the time-consciousness lectures?

- A. Retention belongs to present perception, while recollection newly re-presents what has become absent.
- B. Protention and recollection are identical because both preserve a previously perceived temporal phase.
- C. Primal impression is a datable neural event causally producing the awareness of temporal succession.
- D. Retention is an inference that reconstructs the preceding moment from currently available sensory data.

MCQ 25

Which publication history correctly identifies Husserl's lectures on inner time-consciousness?

- A. Husserl published the completed time-consciousness lectures himself as part of Logical Investigations in 1900.
- B. Edith Stein edited the lecture materials, and Heidegger published the resulting text in 1928.
- C. Heidegger wrote the time-consciousness lectures and later attributed their central argument to Husserl.
- D. The time-consciousness lectures first appeared in the 1931 French edition of Cartesian Meditations.

MCQ 26

How does Husserl's eidetic reduction use free imaginative variation?

- A. It counts observed examples and treats their statistically average features as an essence.
- B. It varies an example in imagination to disclose the invariant without which its kind disappears.
- C. It deduces each essence from axioms accepted before any intuitive examination of examples.
- D. It proves the independent existence of the external world by eliminating imagined alternatives.

MCQ 27

What does Husserl mean by Wesensschau or eidetic intuition?

- A. A mystical vision would disclose Forms existing separately from possible experience.
- B. Empirical comparison would generalise from numerous observed individuals rather than disclose necessity.
- C. Analogical inference would move from familiar objects toward unknown transcendent entities.
- D. Eidetic intuition apprehends the essence disclosed as invariant through free imaginative variation.

MCQ 28

Which classification correctly distinguishes formal from material or regional essences in Husserl's ontology?

- A. Formal essences are real mental acts, while regional essences are ideal contents grasped by those acts.
- B. Formal essences apply to any object, while regional essences govern domains such as body or number.
- C. Formal essences retain the past, while regional essences anticipate the future within temporal consciousness.
- D. Formal essences name noetic acts, while regional essences name their corresponding noematic objects.

MCQ 29

On what basis does Husserl claim a continuity between consciousness and being?

- A. Objects become mere collections of ideas contained inside an individual mind.
- B. The correlational a priori links each kind of being with corresponding modes of conscious givenness.
- C. Divine veracity guarantees agreement between thought and external reality in a Cartesian account.
- D. Hyletic matter and intentional form become numerically identical components of one experience.

MCQ 30

Which account distinguishes Husserl's eidetic reduction from empirical induction and Platonic separation?

- A. Eidetic reduction brackets essences so that phenomenology remains confined to factual description.
- B. Eidetic reduction infers forms by measuring feature frequencies across observed instances.
- C. Eidetic reduction proves that invariant Forms subsist separately from possible conscious disclosure.
- D. Eidetic reduction uses free imaginative variation to disclose invariants within possible experience.

MCQ 31

How should categorial intuition and eidetic intuition be related in Husserl's development?

- A. Both expressions are interchangeable names for ordinary sensory perception of individual physical qualities.
- B. Both expressions refer to subjective feelings that accompany belief without providing objective evidence.
- C. Categorial intuition gives forms or states of affairs, while eidetic intuition apprehends essences through variation.
- D. Neither doctrine concerns givenness because each replaces evidence with purely deductive metaphysical reasoning.

MCQ 32

What is Husserl's transcendental ego after the transcendental reduction?

A. The transcendental ego is the empirical psyche examined as one causal object among others. B. The transcendental ego is Descartes' *res cogitans* understood as an independently existing mental substance. C. The transcendental ego is Kant's purely formal logical unity without habituality or sedimented history. D. The transcendental ego is the constituting field of sense bearing habitualities and sedimented history.

MCQ 33

How does Husserl's account of the 'I think' differ from Descartes' *cogito*?

A. Husserl follows Descartes by inferring a mental substance directly from the occurrence of thinking. B. Husserl treats transcendental subjectivity as worldless and capable of existing without intentional correlates. C. Husserl rejects the substance inference and needs no divine bridge because the world was bracketed. D. Descartes treats his ego as essentially world-constituting through intentionality and temporal synthesis.

MCQ 34

What does *Lebenswelt* designate in Husserl's late analysis of the sciences?

A. *Lebenswelt* designates the mathematised universe described independently by modern theoretical physics. B. *Lebenswelt* designates a realm of essences subsisting separately from embodied historical experience. C. *Lebenswelt* designates the pre-scientific lived horizon presupposed by scientific idealisation. D. *Lebenswelt* designates another name for the transcendental ego after all worldly content disappears.

MCQ 35

Which statement accurately records the publication history of Husserl's *Crisis of European Sciences*?

A. Husserl published the complete *Crisis* as a finished book during his lifetime in 1936. B. The *Crisis* first appeared as the 1931 French translation of the *Cartesian Meditations*. C. Heidegger composed the *Crisis* in 1927 as an extension of *Being and Time*. D. Parts I and II appeared in 1936, while the complete *Crisis* was published posthumously in 1954.

MCQ 36

How does Husserl diagnose the crisis produced by scientific objectivism's treatment of the life-world?

A. Scientific objectivism causally manufactures the world through transcendental consciousness and mathematical symbols. B. Scientific objectivism proves the external world unreal by completing *epoché* within ordinary research practice. C. Scientific objectivism forgets the lived evidential ground from which its mathematical abstractions derive meaning. D. Scientific objectivism identifies *noesis* and *noema* as physiological components underlying acts of measurement.

MCQ 37

What doctrine does Husserl criticise under the name psychologism?

- A. Psychologism holds that logical truths belong to an ideal domain irreducible to mental events.
- B. Psychologism treats logical laws as empirical generalisations about how human beings actually think.
- C. Psychologism treats essences as separated Platonic Forms existing outside possible intuition altogether.
- D. Psychologism requires epoché before the world can be accepted as an intentional correlate.

MCQ 38

Which Prolegomena argument distinguishes logical necessity from psychological generalisation?

- A. Logic is a specialised branch of physics because inference depends upon embodied causal processes.
- B. Truth is whatever a human species feels compelled to accept under normal psychological conditions.
- C. Essences are internal images whose recurrence explains why logical judgements appear universally valid.
- D. Logical laws claim necessity, while psychological laws remain probable inductions from observed thinking.

MCQ 39

What positive account of logical meaning does Husserl oppose to psychologism?

- A. Logical validity ultimately reduces to the causal regularities governing ordinary human reasoning.
- B. Real acts can intend identical ideal and atemporal meanings whose validity exceeds those acts.
- C. Logical meanings are Platonic objects inaccessible to any concrete act of understanding or judgement.
- D. Truth varies with the cognitive constitution of each biological species and historical community.

MCQ 40

How does Husserl's transcendental phenomenology answer the renewed charge of psychologism?

- A. It derives logical necessity from regularities discovered within the empirical psyche after introspection.
- B. It says an individual consciousness causally creates truths and objects through private mental activity.
- C. It makes validity depend upon whichever meanings a historically situated human community happens to share.
- D. It appeals to a non-empirical ego, constitutive disclosure and intersubjective validity rather than mental causation.

MCQ 41

Which distinction is central to Husserl's rejection of psychologistic explanations of logic?

- A. The decisive distinction separates consciousness from the body as two independently existing substances.
- B. The decisive distinction separates empirical idealism from transcendental idealism as rival metaphysical systems.
- C. The decisive distinction separates an act's causal genesis from the ideal validity of

its content. D. The decisive distinction separates the natural attitude from the life-world as unrelated experiential domains.

MCQ 42

Through what mechanism does Husserl constitute the sense of another subject in the Fifth Cartesian Meditation?

- A. An inductive argument infers a hidden mind as the most likely cause of observed bodily movement. B. The other's stream of consciousness is presented originally and directly within one's own experience. C. Divine veracity guarantees that perceived bodies contain minds resembling the perceiver's own mind. D. Passive pairing of lived bodies motivates appresentation as an analogical transfer of embodied sense.

MCQ 43

What question is Husserl principally answering in the Fifth Cartesian Meditation?

- A. He seeks a deductive proof that other minds exist as substances outside his consciousness. B. He seeks empirical evidence sufficient to refute all sceptical hypotheses about other persons. C. He clarifies how another subject and a shared world acquire their proper sense and evidence. D. He derives an alter ego from the innate idea of a truthful and benevolent God.

MCQ 44

What role does pairing play when another body appears as a lived centre in Husserl's account?

- A. Pairing deduces another mind from bodily movement through a consciously performed argument by analogy. B. Pairing presents the other's private experiences directly inside the perceiver's own stream of consciousness. C. Pairing passively associates bodies and transfers the sense of lived embodiment without original access. D. Pairing converts behavioural resemblance into infallible certainty about each hidden psychological event.

MCQ 45

Why must the other subject be appresented rather than originally presented in Husserl's Fifth Meditation?

- A. Original access fails because epoché removes intentional meaning from the behaviour of another body. B. Original access would make the other's stream one's own and thereby destroy the sense of genuine otherness. C. Appresentation is necessary because other persons are theoretical entities posited exclusively by natural science. D. Appresentation replaces embodied empathy after phenomenological reduction eliminates bodily experience from inquiry.

MCQ 46

Which objection expresses Alfred Schutz's circularity criticism of Husserl's sphere of ownness?

A. The supposedly purified ownness sphere may already presuppose the shared world needed to identify embodied selfhood. B. The Fifth Meditation uses mathematical induction rather than free imaginative variation to derive regional essences. C. The account reduces logical validity to acquired habits and therefore repeats Husserl's early psychologism. D. The account denies temporal synthesis and therefore cannot explain the persistence of another perceived body.

MCQ 47

Which ownership boundary correctly limits Topic 09 while allowing supporting Husserlian material?

A. Inner time-consciousness is a separately printed syllabus limb directly owned without connection to method. B. Horizons and intersubjectivity may support owned answers, while life-world and successors remain bounded extensions. C. The complete Crisis replaces the printed syllabus limb concerning phenomenological method and reduction. D. Heidegger's fundamental ontology should be presented as the final phase of Husserl's own system.

MCQ 48

Which comparison accurately identifies a successor's departure from Husserlian phenomenology?

A. Merleau-Ponty questions complete reduction and replaces inert hyle plus imposed form with embodied perception. B. Heidegger preserves the transcendental ego unchanged and confines phenomenology to detached theoretical consciousness. C. Sartre places an ego inside consciousness while rejecting consciousness's intentional directedness toward objects. D. Levinas treats constitution of an alter ego as an exhaustive account of ethical transcendence.

MCQ 49

How should the verified 2026 Sartre-Husserl comparison be assigned between Topic 09 and Topic 10?

A. Topic 09 owns the complete comparison because any reference to Husserl overrides the question's primary demand. B. Topics 09 and 10 both count the complete comparison as directly owned to preserve numerical symmetry. C. Neither topic records the comparison because a cross-thinker question cannot have a primary owner. D. Topic 10 owns the Sartre demand, while Topic 09 records a bounded Husserl comparison.

MCQ 50

A scientist treats mathematical idealisation as self-grounding and forgets everyday evidential practices. What is Husserl's diagnosis?

A. Scientific objectivism forgets the life-world from which mathematical abstractions receive sense and evidence. B. Scientific law abolishes the natural attitude because measurement no longer posits an independently existing world. C. Repeatable mental events avoid psychologism by converting logical validity into stable psychological causation. D. Mathematical abstraction itself completes eidetic reduction and automatically discloses all relevant invariant essences.

MCQ 51

Which judgement best integrates Husserl's reduction, theory of essences and rejection of psychologism?

A. Reduction clarifies givenness, variation discloses invariants and anti-psychologism protects validity while constitution remains disputed. B. Reduction disproves the world, variation creates concepts and psychological events establish logical validity. C. Reduction is introspection, variation is empirical induction and anti-psychologism excludes consciousness from philosophy. D. Reduction recovers mental substance, variation discovers separated Forms and natural science grounds logical laws.

MCQ 52

Which provenance statement about Husserl's major works is historically defensible?

A. Cartesian Meditations first appeared in German in 1931 and was translated into French afterward. B. Ideas II and Ideas III were published together with Ideas I as a completed trilogy in 1913. C. Ideas I appeared in 1913, while the Crisis appeared partly in 1936 and completely in 1954. D. Husserl prepared the time-consciousness lectures for publication without editorial intervention in 1928.

MCQ 53

Why is the claim 'constitution is not fabrication' important when assessing Husserl's transcendental idealism?

A. Constitution makes validity private to the empirical experience that psychologically produces each meaning. B. Constitution discloses sense in subjectivity without claiming that an empirical mind creates truths or objects. C. Constitution turns transcendental idealism into Berkeley's doctrine that finite perceiving produces existing things. D. Constitution removes intersubjectivity because one transcendental ego privately guarantees objective validity.

MCQ 54

How should the sentence "one might as well try to explain astronomy by the psychology of astronomers" be used in a Husserl answer?

A. It should be quoted as Frege's exact wording in his 1894 review of Husserl's early arithmetic. B. It should be identified as a textbook paraphrase that captures the objection but is not Frege's verified wording. C. It should be attributed to Husserl's 1911 essay as his definition of philosophy as rigorous science. D. It should be cited as Mohanty's conclusion that Frege had no relation to Husserl's anti-psychologism.

MCQ 55

Which statement most accurately describes the relation between Frege's 1894 review and Husserl's anti-psychologistic reversal?

A. Frege's review demonstrably caused the reversal, and Husserl expressly acknowledged that causal dependence. B. Frege's review was irrelevant because Husserl neither read it nor encountered related Bolzanian or Lotzean arguments. C. Frege's review pushed Husserl from logic toward descriptive psychology until Ideas I reversed the change in 1913. D. Frege's review coincided with and probably sharpened a reversal whose causal sources remain disputed among scholars.